

Which scenario best illustrates dishabituation? An intensive care unit nurse:

- ☐ A. finds the beeping from medical monitors increasingly annoying over time. [6%]
- ☐ B. no longer notices the beeping from medical monitors over time. [13%]
- ☐ C. ignores the background noise of medical monitors beeping but notices and responds to a critical alarm. [10%]
- ✔ ☒ D. no longer noticed the beeping from medical monitors before vacation but notices it again upon returning to work. [69%]

Correct

69% answered correctly

Explanation:

Nonassociative learning	
Habituation	Decreased response to a stimulus over time (eg, no longer noticing that a sweater feels scratchy after wearing it for a few minutes)
Dishabituation	A renewed response to a previously habituated stimulus (eg, after taking off the sweater & then putting it back on, it feels scratchy again)
Sensitization	Increased response to a stimulus over time (eg, sweater's scratchiness becomes more irritating until it is unbearable)
Desensitization	Decreased response to a previously sensitized stimulus over time (eg, irritation from previously unbearable scratchiness diminishes over time)

Habituation is characterized by a **decrease** in a **response** after **repeated exposure** to a stimulus. For example, a nurse might initially notice the beeping (stimulus) from medical monitors but notice the beeping less over time (diminished response).

Dishabituation occurs when a **previously habituated** stimulus produces a **response again**. For example, a nurse returns from vacation to find that beeping from the medical monitors, which he/she had learned to ignore before vacation (ie, previously habituated stimulus), is noticeable once again (ie, renewed response).

(Choice A) Sensitization occurs when a stimulus produces an increasing response, and desensitization occurs when a response to a sensitized stimulus is reduced. A scenario in which a nurse finds beeping from medical monitors increasingly annoying over time illustrates *sensitization*, not dishabituation.

(Choice B) Habituation is characterized by a decrease in the strength of a response after repeated exposure to a stimulus. A scenario in which a nurse no longer notices the beeping from medical monitors over time illustrates *habituation*, not dishabituation.

(Choice C) Selective attention describes focusing on one stimulus and ignoring others. A scenario in which a nurse ignores the background noise of beeping medical monitors but responds to a critical alarm illustrates *selective attention*, not dishabituation.

Educational objective:

Habituation is characterized by a decrease in a response after repeated exposure to a stimulus. Dishabituation occurs when a previously habituated stimulus produces a response again.

Time spent:0 sec
Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:402268
System:
Learning, Memory, and Cognition

In a two-part procedure for teaching children with diabetes to self-inject insulin, a child is first shown a video of same-aged peers self-injecting insulin and is then given a sticker for each attempt to self-inject. This procedure utilizes:

- ☐ A. Classical conditioning and secondary reinforcement [2%]
- ☐ B. Classical conditioning and a token economy [1%]
- ☐ C. Observational learning and a token economy [36%]
- ✔ ☒ D. Observational learning and secondary reinforcement [59%]

Correct

59% answered correctly

Explanation:

Types of learning	
Operant conditioning	Occurs when the likelihood of repeating a behavior is influenced by the outcome of that behavior
Classical conditioning	Occurs when a stimulus that did not previously elicit a meaningful response takes on the properties of a biologically arousing stimulus after being paired
Observational learning	Occurs as the result of watching others engage in a behavior

Observational learning occurs as the result of **watching others** engage in a **behavior**. For example, a child learns how to self-inject insulin by watching peers self-inject in a video. There are four processes critical to observational learning: attention (focusing on others' behavior), retention (storing observations in memory), reproduction (imitating others' behavior), and motivation (incentive to imitate behavior).

Operant conditioning occurs when the likelihood of repeating a behavior is influenced by a consequence (ie, reinforcement or punishment). Positive reinforcement increases/maintains behavior through the application of a desirable stimulus (ie, reinforcer). Primary reinforcers are naturally rewarding (eg, candy), whereas **secondary reinforcers** are **conditioned** to be desirable (eg, stickers).

Therefore, a child learning to self-inject insulin by watching peers utilizes *observational learning* and rewarding the child with a sticker for attempting to self-inject utilizes *secondary reinforcement*.

(Choices A and B) Classical conditioning occurs when a neutral stimulus that did not previously elicit a response takes on the properties of a biologically arousing (ie, unconditioned) stimulus after being paired (eg, infant fears a white toy rat after it is paired with a loud noise). The procedure does not utilize classical conditioning.

(Choices B and C) In a token economy, certain behaviors (eg, completing homework) are positively reinforced through the use of tokens (eg, gold stars), which are secondary reinforcers that can be exchanged for a desirable reward (eg, 5 gold stars can be

exchanged for candy). The procedure does not involve *trading in secondary reinforcers for a desirable reward*, so it is not utilizing a token economy.

Educational objective:

Observational learning occurs as the result of watching others. Primary reinforcers are naturally rewarding (eg, food), whereas secondary reinforcers are conditioned to be desirable (eg, money).

Time spent:0 sec

Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:402269

System:
Learning, Memory, and Cognition